

Federation: Flourish Federation

Date: 20/04/23

Report: Governor and visit report **DPE consultant:** Stuart Lee (SL) **School**
: Victoria McConnell (VC)

Previous compliance actions

The Federation had a remote compliance meeting with SL on 29/11/22 which supported identifying gaps in the Federations Privacy Programme and follow up actions required. The Federation has updated their compliance documents and have a dedicated data protection section on the Federation website with the latest key documents listed. Staff have either completed or were in the process of completing DPEs GDPR and Stay Safe Online NCSC training. SARs are logged and the DPE dashboard is used to record data breaches and raise tickets. The Federation has full access to DPE resources and support. The Federation has taken a proactive approach to data protection which is evident in the progress made in ensuring data protection compliance.

Audit walk feedback

Onsite visits took place on the 20th April 2023. This was arranged to complete a physical audit of Flourish Federation schools. Schools visited were:

- All Saints Stibbard
- North Elmham

Each school visited in general exhibited good data protection practices and it was rewarding as a consultant to observe how the Federation and schools had already started to advance in their use of cloud based solutions for processing, sharing and storing school data securely, for example: using CPOMS for Safeguarding and cloud-based solutions for file sharing, rather than physical data and folders.

Speaking to staff it was evident that awareness had been raised, for example, forename only was being predominantly used for lists and displays.

The following documents/best practice areas on the DPE website can be used to reference against and to obtain additional resources detailed in the report:

- [DPE consent guidance](#)
- [DPE quick reference guide](#)
- [Records management best practice are](#)
- [CCTV](#)
- [Information and cyber security](#)

Audit walk observations and recommendations:

Visitor sign in

Paper sign-ins were used although not all had visitor statements available. Schools did not request ID although both schools were aware of my visit and that I was being supervised by VC.

Recommendations: Add the following statement to the sign in systems: Visitor information is collected for health and safety, record of official visits and safeguarding. If you would like to know more, the general/visitors privacy notice is available on the school website, or you can ask at reception for a paper copy (paper copy could go on the notice board).

Remind staff to complete ID checks when the visitor is not known to the school.

Front/reception office/offices

Offices in general had sufficient lockable storage for sensitive documents/information.

Generally good practice with shredders in use. Areas were relatively clear of clutter.

Stibbard Office:

- Confidential waste was laying on top of the shredder.
- Bus lists on open display.
- Care plan folder on open display.
- No secure entry to the office.

Recommendations:

- Adjust the process to have a folder/container to add confidential waste until it is shredded, or shred sensitive data straight away.
- Reverse bus lists so that general information is not on display.
- Discussed end of day routines to include adding any sensitive folders to secure storage.
- Consider options for adding a fob or key code to the admin office.

North Elmham Office:

- CCTV base unit and display not secure.
- Memory stick left in base unit.
- Attendance folder observed.
- Key cabinet was open and SL was able to access all keys to all areas.
- Performance management files in cabinet with data going back to 2011.

Recommendations:

- VC to review the Federation CCTV policy documentation and ascertain whether the unit is for H&S or used for recorded CCTV. Once confirmed VC can notify SL for

support with policy documentation. DPEs CCTV best practice area and policy documentation is [here](#).

- VC to check on the use and contents of the memory stick and if it contains sensitive data.
- VC to review the procedure for locking the key cabinet with staff access. Federation could consider a mini key code key safe to add the key cabinet key to.
- VC to discuss with staff the completion of a data cleanse and securely destroy outdated personnel files (refer to the Federations retention schedule).

Day care managers office

Notebook on open display with medical/risk assessment information.

Recommendation: Secure sensitive data when not in your work area.

Nursery/PPA room

SLT pupil progress folders.

Recommendation: Secure sensitive data when not in your work area.

Group room

SEND folder in cabinet unlocked.

1 x sheet containing UN and PW for dglogin.

Recommendation:

Secure sensitive data.

Remind all staff of the importance of not leaving UN and PWs laying around. Consider adopting DPEs [Password policy](#).

Photo displays at reception and school website

Staff names are displayed on the Federation website and in an open area of the Federation reception area.

Recommendation: Federation to check latest consent (refer to reference document above) and if not obtained, reissue the consent form to staff, especially for photos on the Federation website.

Photocopiers (Federation)

Photocopiers had no secure codes.

Recommendation: To minimise the risk of sensitive data being left on photocopiers add a secure printing option to the Federations photocopiers.

Classrooms

VC confirmed that work had taken place to increase staff awareness regarding what information should and should not be on display. This was clearly evident when completing the walk with minimal data on display, or in physical folders. There is a lack of lockable storage at North Elmham although this is not now an issue; as the school is now utilising Cloud based solutions.

Recommendations: One staff member spoken to was not fully aware of the procedure/process for allergy/medical information and where this could be accessed. VC to raise staff awareness and ensure a consistent approach across the Federation. VC could

consider just having one folder kept in the front office and the rest accessed via the MIS/Cloud systems. VC to review.

Medical room and staffroom

It is noted that at some settings, medical information is pinned to the staffroom and/or medical room wall. Information has been minimised to photo, forename and medical/allergy.

Filing cabinet at Stibbard had sensitive attendance data.

Door is locked although the key to access the medical room is on the wall outside the medical room.

Recommendation: Areas are secure with restricted access. As a minimum you can consider a front cover or folder system and assess whether eventually you can move to electronic systems and possibly one physical copy kept securely in the front office(s).

Add keycode/fob entry to improve security.

Corridor storage arrears and storage in general

It was evident that VC had already made good progress in completing a data cleanse of cupboards, cabinets and storage areas. VC acknowledges that this is a work in progress so there is still some work required to complete this.

Recommendation: Continue to work through areas and folders and destroy outdated information, for example, the cupboards in the corridor at Stibbard still had some outdated sensitive information in folders.

Locking of computers

Recommendations: There were locations where staff were still logged in but not in their work area. At Stibbard, the day care managers office, the unlocked desktop allowed account access.

Remind staff to use **Windows key + L** to lock laptops/desktops when not in the work area.

Consider additional training for staff i.e DPE's [Password nugget training](#).

Adopt DPEs [Password Policy](#).

Physical security (extended services)

Recommendation: As the Federation are considering opening up to extended services a review of public access to areas should be completed prior to the use of the premises by members of the public.

Follow up actions:

- Action recommendations from the audit walk findings.
- Disseminate the Federations retention schedule to staff and use it as a working document.
- Review consent forms, guidance, procedures and processes, especially in preparation for the new intake.
- Ensure all staff have completed GDPR and Stay Safe Online NCSC training and if not already, incorporate as part of the induction process with new staff.
- Continue to raise awareness across the Federation.
- Work with SL as appropriate for CCTV and additional compliance documents.